

fraction of the 150 Mbps theoretical limit that Wireless N offers, it does make a bit of a difference for those looking to transfer large files over a wireless network or those looking to stream 1080p content over more than one client – a situation that occurs very rarely, but it is a usage scenario. The advantage of a 5-GHz band is that it suffers no interference, whereas the 2.4-GHz band is more common, being shared by cellular and radio signals, Bluetooth devices and such. There is a difference between dual-band and dual-band simultaneous devices – the latter allow both 2.4 and 5 GHz bands to be used simultaneously.

One thing you must keep in mind when shopping is the distance the wireless client is going to be placed from the router and the solid obstacles in between. Metal, concrete and therefore walls are great signal attenuators and will scramble nearly any signal. This is where the dual-band, MIMO routers come in, they offer slightly extended coverage and a slightly more powerful signal and this can make all the difference. Thankfully, you needn't have a clear line-of-sight in case there is a wooden door or glass window somewhere in the room, preferably in the general direction of the room in which the router is placed as signals pass through wood and glass without notable loss. If you have a smaller house and are only looking to connect a single notebook, don't spend more than Rs. 3,000.



Netgear WNR2000

The second shop had the Linksys WRT610N, which is a simultaneous dual-band router with a USB port, this is known as storage link, a fancy name, but what it actually allows is usage of any external USB-based storage to be accessed on the same IP as the router – good for file sharing. This router was priced at Rs. 9,000 – a bit too costly for me. The WRT320N from Linksys was also on display. Priced at Rs. 6,500 this router has two N bands, but you can use either of 2.4 or 5 GHz, not simultaneously. The four LAN ports are advertised as Gigabit, but this is no big deal to be honest. Both these routers support MIMO, which is useful for greater reliability since it creates multiple connection tunnels that improve signal integrity. Upon asking for